

Jessica Alba Dynasty League – 2021 Season Review

I. Introduction

We made it all the way to week 17, just! Thank you all once again for your cooperation and commitment throughout the season. I know we've needed to bring in the protocols again but thankfully never needed to fully use them.

I think the league has developed really well. All the non-playoff teams made the most of their picks and made it to the playoffs this year, with the final two the same teams from last year's consolation bowl!

Congratulations to Dave for going from best loser to belt winner! Commiserations to Rich for coming just short and for Alex for winning the consolation bowl but not actually getting the number one pick. These draft pick trades not without risk but this is the first time someone's cashed one in and not made the playoffs.

II. Results

So, the final table looks like this:

1. Dave – Dak to the Future (7-7)
2. Rich – Inch by Inch (6-8)
3. Jebus – Saquontum Leap (12-2)
4. Mike – Tompa Bay Bucs (8-6)
5. Ross – Justin Allentown (8-6)
6. Neil – Canton Giants (8-6)
7. Alex – Kittle-less Chips (6-8)
8. Lee – Jazzy Jefferson and The Fresh Jameis (5-9)
9. Chris – Newbrook Falcons (5-9)
10. Gareth – I am the Waller and Russ (5-9)

Many congratulations must go to Dave. It was a bit of a hit and miss season, making it to the playoffs with a .500 record but won when he needed to to take the Championship. He was tested by Rich in the championship game but pushed through with good performances from Dak, Ekeler and the timeless Gronk.

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Whilst most of the plaudits will rightly go to the championship winning team, the early running and regular season was won by your noble Commissioner. His team may have only lost 3 times but they were all to the eventual winner, most notably in Week 16. I'm sure we all remember the eight-game winning streak that helped him take the regular season.

The results aren't confined to the final table and people who actually won things but also the affect the playoffs and Consolation Bowl has on the draft (as things stand):

Round 1	Round 2	Round 3	Round 4	Round 5
1. ROSS (via Alex)	1. LEE (via Alex)	1. DAVE (via Alex)	1. ALEX	1. ALEX
2. GARETH	2. GARETH	2. GARETH	2. GARETH	2. GARETH
3. CHRIS	3. CHRIS	3. CHRIS	3. CHRIS	3. CHRIS
4. LEE	4. LEE	4. LEE	4. LEE	4. LEE
5. NEIL	5. CHRIS (via Neil)	5. NEIL	5. NEIL	5. NEIL
6. ROSS	6. LEE (via Ross)	6. JEBUS (via Ross)	6. ROSS	6. ROSS
7. MIKE	7. MIKE	7. DAVE (via Mike)	7. MIKE	7. MIKE
8. ROSS (via Jebus)	8. ROSS (via Jebus)	8. DAVE (via Jebus)	8. JEBUS	8. JEBUS
9. RICH	9. RICH	9. RICH	9. RICH	9. RICH
10. LEE (via Dave)	10. MIKE (via Dave)	10. DAVE	10. DAVE	10. DAVE

Congratulations clearly need to go to Alex as he won the Consolation Bowl (Corral Cup). His stellar team was unfortunately hit hard by injuries and just missed out on the playoffs. Unfortunately, as noted above, he won't be able to reap the rewards of the win but I'm certain that Ross will try and make the most of it! We can all now wonder who he will pick. Alternatively, we can all bombard him with trade offers to get the same opportunity. What will it take for the hoarder of young QBs to relieve him of the opportunity to draft yet another one? It'll be like watching Draft Day all over again.

III. I am the Waller and Russ – Gareth

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2021 Draft Pick	Trades
5	9	9	9	0	2	10	2	0

Gareth had a league power ranking of 91 which put him fourth the league for this season. Alas injuries to Waller and Russ and Sanders, CEH and Woods put the unchanged side from 2020 in some difficulty and a ninth-place regular season finish. Gareth was one three GMs not to make any in-season trades and like the others it is a what might have been if he'd taken some of those offers given how poorly some of his players performed.

Unfortunately for Gareth, he wasn't able to make the most of the consolation bracket and take the 1.01 and has found himself on the dreaded Wall of Shame.

What now for G after, as Lee so aptly put it, the No Trade Experiment proved to be a failure? He has the 1.02 but it looks like that's not going to be enough to rebuild this team. Trading for 2022 and 2023 picks is an option if he can ease his grasp on his better players. Otherwise, he could trade away his own draft capital to reinforce his side and see if he can recapture that form which put him second last year. Either way he's got to start making some moves or he may find himself in a bit of a predicament.

IV. Newbrook Falcons – Chris

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2021 Draft Pick	Trades
5	9	6	9	1	1	9	3	2

Chris had a league power ranking of 77 which put him eighth in the league for this season. Whilst he was hoping to buck the so-called experts expectations, he ended the regular season rock bottom. He made two trades in-season swapping young stud RB Joe Mixon (and a 2023 2nd) for the King and mercurial Michael Thomas and, Gronk for a 2022 2nd. Clear indicators that the writing was on the wall by mid-season for the ~~Felons~~ Falcons and the focus is on winning 2022.

Probably best to not mention too much more about this season but whilst he finished rock bottom, he did avoid the dreaded Loser of All Losers and the golden turd that goes with it and has a top three pick at the 2022 draft.

It seems pretty clear that Chris intends to take his team of intrepid veterans (and Joe Burrow) and have a crack at winning it all in 2022. This probably relies a little on his chief felon avoiding any criminal or NFL charges and taking to the field in 2022. Perhaps he takes another young QB with that 1.03, or maybe he packages that to get a more established QB from elsewhere?

V. Jazzy Jefferson and The Fresh Jameis – Lee

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2022 Draft Pick	Trades
5	9	5	8	1	1	8	4	2

Lee had a league power ranking of 90 which put him fifth in the league for this season. His team let him down spending much of the season battling for bottom spot but eventually finishing eighth. He made a couple of trades looking to the future of his franchise once it became pretty clear he wasn't going to challenge for the belt in 2021.

He did make it to the No. 1 pick final but ran into too much quality in Alex's team in the consolation final. He still has two picks in the first round this year (after his three last year) and 8 overall picks.

Can he finally capitalise on his extra picks again and form a team ready to challenge in 2022 or will he cash those high value lottery tickets in for those elusive stud QBs and RBs to get him over the line when it matters?

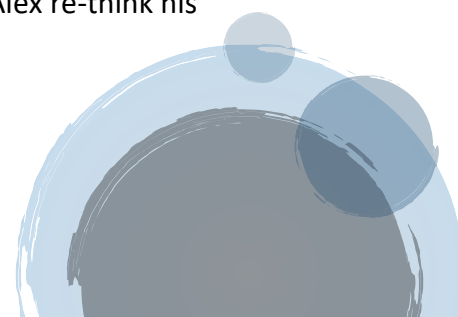
VI. Kittle-less Chips – Alex

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2022 Draft Pick	Trades
6	8	8	7	2	0	7	1 (31)	1

Alex had a league power ranking of 100 which put him top in the league for the season. He eventually fell below these expectations finishing seventh. Alex made very few in-season changes to his team having committed so much in the off-season before.

It's a real shame that Alex's team once again was without the #1 pick from the startup draft Christian McCaffrey. He didn't just suffer from that injury, he also lost Kyler Murray and George Kittle for long stints in the season. Alex had a very strong start to the season but without the spine of his team available it's no wonder he struggled.

The question now is what can he do to address his poor season? Is the return of CMC the catalyst to get his team firing again in 2022 or will some new blood and smart trading push his team with so much potential to new heights? Or will a second disappointing season make Alex re-think his prospects and look to rebuild his team and go again in 23/24?



VII. Canton Giants – Neil

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2021 Draft Pick	Trades
8	6	4	4	0	2	6	5	3

Neil had a league power ranking of 73 which put him ninth in the league for this season but secured himself an unexpected playoff spot in Week 13! He made the second most in season trades, 67% of which were surprisingly with Dave!? They did at least temporarily improve his QB room.

Whilst he finished 4th unfortunately, he suffered badly from the now infamous Week 15 and limped into 6th place. He'll be no doubt delighted he avoided the golden turd and that his teams made progress.

What's next for the Canton Giants? A mid round pick means another desperately needed QB is unlikely to be available. Could he cash in on his big players like Kupp and Kamara and rebuild for the future or stick with his aging stars and hope for another playoff run in 2022?

VIII. Justin Allentown – Ross

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2021 Draft Pick	Trades
8	6	10	3	1	1	5	6 (1)	1

Ross had a league power ranking of 66 which put him bottom of the league for this season but what do the experts know, eh? He went and made the playoffs again but suffered from the strange Week 15 scores. He made just one trade in-season, adding a very much needed RB in exchange for a what appears to be superfluous QB, given his strength in that area.

Although he maybe didn't expect to make the playoffs, he did anyway. Without taking the title this may have been more of a hindrance than a help with a now lower draft pick. However, a very shrewd/lucky move in trading Godwin to Alex in the offseason means he now has the 1.01!

Ross now has the capital to choose his fate. He can carry on with his strategy of faith in youth or he could trade in his capital for some more established stars. Which path will he choose? Whatever he does he needs to find some better RBs and TEs to go with those stellar QBs and good WRs.



IX. Tompa Bay Bucs – Mike

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2022 Draft Pick	Trades
8	6	3	2	0	2	4	7	0

Mike had a league power ranking of 83 which put him seventh in the league for this season, so he finished way above he was expected to. He didn't make any changes in season and why would you if your team has secured a bye in Week 13 but did the lack of moves cost him a chance at the championship?

Mike's team of young guns did very well in the regular season with Mahomes, Hurts and Jonathan 'fucking' Taylor pushing his team into second. He was probably one of the teams that suffered the least from injuries but a crucial loss in week 16 means he lost his opportunity to take the belt.

What next for Mike? His team had some breakout players for the 2021 season and if he keeps them and picks well with his rookie draft capital could he make 2022 his year? What's the saying though – *you don't win anything with kids*.

X. Saquontum Leap – Jebus

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2020 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2021 Draft Pick	Trades
12	2	7	1	1	1	3	8 (26)	1

Jebus had a league power ranking of 96 which put him in second in the league for this season. He exceeded those expectations with a dominant regular season and top finish. He made one in-season trade when disaster hit in Week 8 with an injury to King Henry and he needed a replacement. Joe Mixon did an able job of filling those ample shoes.

Last year, statistically, Jebus didn't belong in the playoffs but this year he set some records which will be hard to be beaten. Stats don't matter in the playoffs though and his now nemesis, Dave, is the only team he failed to beat this year (or in fact ever).

Jebus put all his eggs in the 2021 basket and came up short. Can the team that dominated in 2021 do it again but go all the way next year? Will he restock the basket with more eggs in 2022? Or, with some players getting on a bit, will he come to his senses and realise that Dynasty lasts more than three seasons?

XI. Inch by Inch – Rich

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2021 Draft Pick	Trades
6	8	2	6	2	1	2	9	0

Rich had a league power ranking of 85 which put him sixth in the league for this season which is exactly where he ended the regular season. He made no major changes to his roster in season despite suffering numerous injuries to his top players. Did this cost him the title after getting so close but falling short in the championship game?

He made the most of that No. 2 pick position picking up a future franchise QB and Rookie sensation Jaylen Waddle. They helped him secure a last-minute playoff spot and pushed him nearly to the championship.

What will Rich decide to do with his predominantly aging team? He certainly has the players to make one more go but having just scraped into the playoffs this year that must be a concern. He could clearly get some good capital in selling some of those aging stars – it could be the last chance to get any value on some of them. He could build around Fields, Akers and Waddle. The options are endless. Whatever he chooses he needs to commit to it so he doesn't end up stuck in mid table mediocrity.

XII. Dak to the Future – Dave

Regular Season W	Regular Season L	2021 Draft Pick	Regular Season Finish	Post Season W	Post Season L	Final Season Finish	2021 Draft Pick	Trades
7	7	1	5	3	0	1	10 (21)	4

Dave had a league power ranking of 94 which put him third in the league for this season. He fell below that in the regular season (coming fifth) but was of course our eventual winner. Dave's team was also plagued by injuries but he built some decent squad depth but perhaps most crucially made the most in season changes to improve his team with in-form players.

Dave's regular season was a real mixed bag. He had a .500 record and never strung more than two consecutive wins together until the three final playoff games.

Dave's put together a good squad with great depth which has seen him thought this second Covid hit season. He still doesn't have those elite players who put up those 30+ point that creates dominant teams. Having won the Consolation Bowl and Championship does he feel this strategy is the right one or will we see a change of tack in the off-season?

XIII. Conclusion

Congratulations once more to our worthy winner, Dave. Plaudits also go to Alex for successfully navigating the league to take the first-round draft pick and but allowing Ross the privilege of picking it.

Mostly, thanks to all of you for committing to the league and keeping it entertaining and competitive for the whole season. We now have 9 months to inseminate our squads with new blood; carefully hone and develop them and give birth to 10 competitive teams in a new league season.

I hope you've all enjoyed the season and league as much as I have. I look forward to meeting with as many of you as possible on Super Bowl Sunday and then maybe hold our first in-person rookie draft.